Sujal Khatiwada

PHP Engineer · Developer Educator · Community Trainer

ksujan413@gmail.com | LinkedIn | GitHub | Located in Nepal · Available for remote work

PROFILE

Software engineer with 6+ years building web apps and REST APIs, mostly in PHP. I also write courses and teach programming online and in workshops, with a focus on basics done properly and learning by building. I spend a lot of time explaining technical ideas in plain language, whether that is to beginners or to people already writing code.

OPEN SOURCE / DOCS

Official PHP docs: issue on the official docs repo

Feb 2025

Found a bad BCMath example on the PHP 8.4 release docs. It broke under `declare(strict_types=1)`. I opened an issue on the official PHP docs repo; the sample was corrected and merged. github.com/php/doc-en/issues/4466

sujal/validation: PHP validation library

Open source · MIT

A PHP validation library built around reusable Rule classes. Immutable Schema of Fields, PHP 8.2+, no framework required, PHPUnit tests included. Built so new rules are new classes, not changes to the engine.
github.com/sujalK/validation

voxgig/sdkgen: upstream tooling issues (credited)

2026 · searchapi-google-sdk

Reported sdkgen gaps found while building a PHP SDK: npm create flag forwarding, quickstart examples, scaffold recovery, generated ownership metadata, and noisy warnings. Maintainer opened tracked issues with severity labels and credited my reports.

- #236 · npm create options (high)
- #239 · quickstart params & API keys (high)
- #240 · scaffold failure recovery (high)
- #235 · ownership metadata (medium)
- #237 · actionable warnings (low)

WHY THIS ROLE

- Day-to-day work is PHP and APIs: Symfony, API Platform, REST, Composer, GitHub.
- I started teaching on Udemy in 2018. That course now has 43,000+ students in 150+ countries.
- Invited to run JavaScript workshops for ITSNP and Code for Change in Nepal.
- I write short posts and videos in developer groups on LinkedIn and Facebook, mostly about PHP, Symfony, JavaScript, and how I think about software design.
- I notice when docs or examples are wrong. See the PHP docs issue above.
- Most of my freelance work has been remote, with clients outside Nepal.

DEVELOPER EDUCATION & COMMUNITY

Udemy Instructor

Ongoing

- 43,000+ students in 150+ countries. The course starts from programming basics and works up with practical examples.
- I plan lessons so people get past “hello world” and into solving actual problems.

Software Engineering Instructor & Curriculum Designer

2018 – Present

- Write and teach courses for mixed groups: people new to code, and people switching careers.
- I try to show how software is actually built and shipped, not only language syntax.

Community Workshops

- **IT Students of Nepal (ITSNP):** Invited to train a one-month live JavaScript workshop.
- **Code for Change (Nepal):** Ran hands-on JavaScript workshops in Kathmandu. They asked me back more than once.

LinkedIn posts related to PHP (hands-on coding)

Picked work to showcase relevant hands-on PHP examples and practical use cases of various design patterns. The links below open the actual posts on LinkedIn.

- How modern PHP frameworks use the Builder Pattern
- Observer Pattern in Symfony (CompilerPass + SOLID)

SELECTED TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Software Developer, Upwork

Aug 2020 – Present

- 25+ client projects finished, mostly backend, REST APIs, and front-end work.
- Talk directly with clients abroad about what to build, when it ships, and how handoff works.
- I run PHPUnit and end-to-end API checks before I mark something done.

Case study: Online learning platform (New York client)

Upwork

Government school in New York · used daily by hundreds of students

- Built a PHP learning site students use in class, plus an admin panel so staff can manage the content.
- Suggested the learning methods to the client, then coded them into the product.

Stack: PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, JS, jQuery

REST API for an e-commerce store

Solo project

Store API I built myself: products, cart/checkout, user accounts. Backend is PHP, Symfony, and API Platform. Token auth, Stripe payments, images on AWS S3, and order/account emails through Symfony Mailer. github.com/sujalK/ecommerce-api

Vue Drive (file manager)

Solo project

Google Drive–style app: upload files, nest folders, search, star items, and browse recent files. Vue 3 frontend (Vite, Vue Router, Pinia) with an Express API for JWT auth and Multer uploads. github.com/sujalK/vue-drive

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **PHP & APIs:** PHP, Symfony, API Platform, REST APIs, Doctrine ORM, Composer
- **Web:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Vue.js, responsive UI
- **Testing & tools:** PHPUnit, functional API testing, Git / GitHub
- **Teaching side:** courses, workshops, video posts, and writing in developer groups on LinkedIn and Facebook

EDUCATION

London Metropolitan University, BSc (Hons.) Computing

2023

Graduated with First Class Honours

LANGUAGES

- Nepali (Native)
- English (Professional)
- Hindi (Good communication)

LINKS

- Udemy: udemy.com/user/sujal-12
- Upwork: Upwork profile
- LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/sujal-k-0b3b04126
- GitHub: github.com/sujalK
- Portfolio: sujalk.github.io/portfolio